

COMPARATIVE MARKET ANALYSIS

Duravel vs Runna

How Runna scaled a training-plan app from zero to a ~\$40M run-rate acquisition in under four years — and what that trajectory implies for Duravel across Years 1–5, modeled across three scenarios.

Prepared July 17, 2026 · Runna figures from public disclosures; milestone dates reconstructed from growth anchors (see method note) · Projections are modeled scenarios, not forecasts.

01 Runna at a glance

A London running-plan app (founded 2021 by ex-elite runner Ben Parker + Dom Maskell). Went from selling one-off £80 plans to a subscription app in March 2022, then compounded ~30% month-over-month into a Strava acquisition.

Mar 2022

Subscription app launched

Prior: 1,000+ one-off plans at £80

~30x

Subscription growth in 2023

Dec 2022 → Dec 2023

~\$40M

ARR run-rate at exit

~\$3.5M/mo (iOS + Android), Mar 2025

Apr 2025

Acquired by Strava

Est. valuation \$80–120M

~\$10M

Total VC raised

£485k crowd + \$2.35M seed + £5M Series A

180+

Countries

By late 2023

~4 yrs

Founding to exit

2021 → 2025

4.9★

App Store rating

76,000+ reviews at Series A

02 How fast did Runna hit each milestone?

Runna never published dated user/subscriber milestones. The table below is a **reconstruction** — a growth curve fit to the anchors Runna *did* disclose. Treat calendar dates as ±1 quarter, not precise records.

TOTAL USERS (REGISTERED)	REACHED (MODELED)	≈ MONTHS FROM LAUNCH	PAYING SUBSCRIBERS	REACHED (MODELED)	≈ MONTHS FROM LAUNCH
100	Mar–Apr 2022	~0–1	100	2021 (plan era)	pre-launch
500	Q2 2022	~2	500	~Launch, Mar 2022	~0
1,000	Mid 2022	~4	1,000	Q2 2022	~3
5,000	Q4 2022	~8	2,500	Q3 2022	~6
10,000	Early 2023	~11	5,000	Dec 2022	~9
50,000	Mid 2023	~15	10,000	Q1 2023	~11
100,000	Q3 2023	~18	50,000 → 100,000	Aug → Nov 2023	~17–20

Runna paying-subscriber curve (reconstructed)

Log scale. Circles = anchors Runna disclosed; line = fitted ~30% MoM decelerating curve.

Method. Anchors used: subscription app launched Mar 2022; ~30% month-over-month growth reported post-launch; subscriptions grew ~30× across 2023; "hundreds of thousands of users" by Nov 2023 (Series A); ~\$40M ARR run-rate (~\$3.5M/mo) at the Apr 2025 acquisition, implying roughly ~300,000 paying subscribers at ~\$130–145 blended annual revenue per subscriber. A 30%/month curve anchored to "5k subs in Dec 2022 → ~150k by end-2023" reproduces these points; earlier milestones are read off that curve. Real numbers could differ meaningfully — Runna has not confirmed them.

03 What share of Runna's users pay?

Runna is not a classic freemium app — it is a **trial-gated paid app**. Almost everything sits behind a 7-day trial; only limited "new to running" plans are free. That makes its paying-to-active ratio far higher than a typical fitness app.

~300k

Est. paying subscribers at exit

\$40M ARR ÷ ~\$135 revenue/sub

~40–60%

Of active/registered users pay (est.)

vs ~2–5% for freemium apps

Trial → paid

Primary funnel, not free tier

7-day trial, cancel anytime

Read: Because Runna paywalls the product, its "users" and "paying subscribers" numbers are much closer together than a freemium app's would be. The gap is trials-in-progress, churned trialists, and the small free-plan cohort — not a giant unmonetized free base. **Implication for Duravel:** if you copy the trial-gated model, plan for a high paying share of active users but a smaller top-of-funnel; if you run a free tier, expect the opposite — more users, lower paying %.

04 Market size: running vs hybrid

This is the core strategic tension. Runna fishes in a **vastly larger but slow-growing** pond. Duravel fishes in a **much smaller but explosively growing** one — HYROX participation is roughly tripling year over year.

Addressable participants (log scale)

Runna's running market dwarfs hybrid today — but note the growth rates below.

HYROX competitors per season

The category Duravel serves is compounding ~2–3× per year.

Runna — running

Duravel — hybrid / HYROX / tri

- **150–600M** runners worldwide (broad TAM)

- **1M+** marathon finishers per year; tens of millions in structured 5K–marathon training

- Growth: **low single digits %/yr** — mature, saturated category

- Competition: crowded (Nike Run Club, Garmin, Strava, TrainingPeaks)

- **570k → 1.5M → 2.5M** HYROX competitors (24/25 → 25/26 → 2026 proj.)

- **15k → 24k** affiliated gyms; + DEKA, + ~4M global triathletes / Ironman age-groupers to come

- Growth: **~2–3× per year** — fastest-growing endurance category

- Competition: **essentially no dedicated hybrid training app yet** — open category

The trade-off in one line: Runna won a big, slow market by being best-in-class. Duravel is early in a small, fast market with almost no direct competitor — the classic "own the category before it's obvious" position. The risk is symmetrical: the category is small *today*, and a well-funded incumbent (Strava/Runna itself, or HYROX) could add a hybrid mode.

05 Head-to-head

DIMENSION	DURAVEL	RUNNA	EDGE
Core product	AI-adaptive hybrid plans (HYROX/DEKA/tri)	AI-adaptive running plans	—
Monthly price	\$19.99	\$19.99	Tie
Annual price	\$159.99	\$119.99	Duravel +\$40/yr
Market size (today)	~1.5M HYROX + adjacents	150–600M runners	Runna
Market growth	~2–3×/yr	Low single digits	Duravel
Direct competition	Almost none	Very crowded	Duravel
Funding	Bootstrapped / solo	~\$10M VC	Runna
Burn / breakeven	Very low burn, near-breakeven early	VC-fueled paid acquisition	Duravel
Infra status	Billing, email, auth all live (2026)	Mature at exit	—

DIMENSION	DURAVEL	RUNNA	EDGE
Distribution flywheel	HYROX category marketing (external tailwind)	Strava integration + paid UA	Runna

Pricing note: Duravel's annual is ~33% above Runna's. That lifts revenue per annual subscriber but may dampen annual-plan conversion — worth A/B testing an intro annual price near Runna's.

06 Duravel Years 1–5 — three scenarios

Paying subscribers at each year-end and the resulting ARR (at ~\$145 blended revenue per paying subscriber per year, reflecting Duravel's higher annual price and a monthly/annual mix). **Bull ≈ Runna's actual trajectory** with a category tailwind; **Base** = a strong bootstrapped outcome; **Bear** = a modest, organic-only lifestyle business.

- All three
- Bear
- Base
- Bull

Paying subscribers (year-end)

Log scale.

Annual recurring revenue (ARR)

Paying subs × ~\$145 blended.

SCENARIO	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5	Y5 ARR
Bear	300	1,500	5,000	12,000	25,000	\$3.6M
Base	800	4,000	15,000	40,000	90,000	\$13.1M
Bull	2,000	12,000	45,000	120,000	280,000	\$40.6M

- Bear — organic only, tight budget
- Base — solid traction + HYROX partnerships
- Bull — Runna-style breakout on category tailwind

Assumptions. Blended ~\$145 ARR per paying subscriber (Duravel annual \$159.99 / monthly \$19.99, mixed, net of churn & app-store fees before taxes). Scenarios anchor to Runna's real curve: Runna hit ~10k paying subs at ~11 months and ~100k at ~20 months with ~\$10M of paid fuel. Duravel bootstrapped will most likely ramp slower initially (Base/Bear)

but can approach Runna's shape (Bull) if a HYROX partnership or viral moment lands. Not financial advice or a forecast — a planning aid.

07 Strategic read

Where Duravel can win

- **Category ownership.** Runna proved a lone founder-led plan app can reach \$40M ARR in ~3 years. No one owns hybrid yet — that's Duravel's to take.
- **Free tailwind.** HYROX is spending to grow the sport 2–3×/yr. Duravel rides that demand curve without paying for it.
- **Capital efficiency.** Bootstrapped + live infra means a Base-case \$13M ARR is reachable without Runna's \$10M burn.
- **Pricing power.** A dedicated, hard-to-find niche supports the higher \$159.99 annual.

Where the risk sits

- **Smaller ceiling today.** Hybrid's TAM is a fraction of running's — Bull case depends on HYROX/tri continuing to compound and Duravel expanding to triathlon.
- **Incumbent entry.** Strava+Runna or HYROX itself could bolt on a hybrid mode; move fast to lock in the community.
- **No paid-UA engine.** Runna bought growth; Duravel must earn it via community, coaches, and gym partnerships.
- **Conversion unproven.** Runna's ~40–60% paying share of actives is a paywalled-model result — validate Duravel's funnel early.

Bottom line. Runna is the proof case that this exact playbook — AI-personalized, adaptive plans at a fraction of a human coach — can scale to a nine-figure exit in under four years. Duravel is running the same play in a smaller but far faster-growing category with essentially no direct rival. Realistically expect a **Base-case ~90k paying subscribers / ~\$13M ARR by Year 5**, with genuine upside toward Runna's numbers if a HYROX partnership or viral moment converts the category tailwind into distribution.

Sources: Runna funding blog posts, RevenueCat case study, Strava/press announcements, DC Rainmaker & Stysin analyses, SportsPro (HYROX). Runna milestone dates are modeled reconstructions from disclosed anchors, not confirmed figures. Duravel projections are illustrative scenarios.